

Giovanna Ferrari

GRADUATE STUDENT IN MARRIAGE, COUPLE & FAMILY COUNSELING

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PROFILE

Graduate student in Marriage, Couple & Family Counseling and practicing artist with an interest in art therapy and expressive modalities. Brings community experience facilitating art activities for people living with dementia, along with one-on-one online mentoring and creative support. A thoughtful, collaborative communicator with strengths in active listening, organization, facilitation, and creating welcoming spaces for participation and self-expression.

EDUCATION

M.S., Marriage, Couple & Family Counseling · Duquesne University In Progress
CACREP-accredited program · Counselor Education & School Psychology
Laurea in Public Relations · IULM University, Italy 2001

ART & CREATIVE PRACTICE

Artist & Creative Practitioner · Independent Artist · Pittsburgh, PA 2020–Present

- Maintain an independent studio practice focused on contemporary painting and expressive visual exploration.
- Develop and exhibit original artwork through independent and community-based exhibitions.
- Manage creative projects from concept development through production, presentation, communication, and promotion.
- Explore the relationship between visual expression, emotion, memory, and personal experience.
- Participate in the Pittsburgh arts community through exhibitions and creative programming.

ART THERAPY & COMMUNITY VOLUNTEERING

Art Activity Volunteer · Jewish Association on Aging · Pittsburgh, PA Summer 2024

- Provided art classes and art-based activities for individuals living with dementia.
- Used creative engagement to encourage self-expression, connection, and participation.
- Supported participants with patience, empathy, and individualized attention.
- Observed how creative activities can facilitate communication and emotional expression when verbal communication is difficult.

MENTORING & CREATIVE SUPPORT

Online Mentor & Creative Support · Independent Ongoing

- Provide one-on-one mentoring and thoughtful feedback through online, counseling-informed conversations.
- Support people as they explore personal questions and creative challenges through active listening and respectful communication.
- Maintain clear, appropriate boundaries while communicating with people from diverse backgrounds.

STRENGTHS & INTERESTS

Strengths: Interpersonal communication · Active listening · Facilitation · Organization · Collaborative work · One-on-one support · Public engagement · Project coordination
Interests: Art therapy · Expressive modalities · Dementia care · Emotional expression · Community-based arts